No 187. United States Consulate
at Amoy.

DEPARTMENT OF STATE RECEIVED NOV 23 1872
ACKNOWLEDGED DEC 3 1872

Mr. Chas. W. Le Gendre
to the
Department of State.

Subject:- Formosa affairs -- Consul's leave of absence.

Abstract of Content:- Handing copy of Despatch No. to the Minister. Consul will avail himself of the leave of absence granted him, and sail for home on the 13th October.

No. 187. United States Consulate
for Amoy and the depen-
-dencies thereof.

Amoy, October 4th, 1872.

To the
Hon: Assistant Secretary of State,
Washington, D. C.

Sir,

Referring to my despatches
Nos. 168 and 186, I have the
honor to enclose you copy
of my despatch No. 82 with
enclosures, addressed to the
United States Minister at
Peking. (Enclosure No 1) By reference to enclo-
-sure No. 2 with said despatch,
you will perceive that I
have accomplished in Formosa
all that I could possibly do,
and as it is not likely
that the instructions of the
Minister regarding what remains
to be done will arrive before
January next, I have concluded
to avail myself of my leave
of absence and leave for

Some by the steamer of the
12th October. Understanding
that my leave of absence
is to be availed in the man-
ner stated in your despatch
No. 110, and thanking for
your kindness in having
Granted me the same,
I have the honor to be
Sir,
Your Obedient Servant,
C. W. Le Gendre
U. S. Consul.

Enclosure No 1 with Despatch No 89

No. 82. United States Consulate for Amoy
and the dependencies thereof.
Amoy, September 3rd, 1872.

T. F. Low Esq.
Minister Plenipotentiary and
Envoy Extraordinary of the United
States at Peking.
Sir,

Referring to mine No. 79 and so
I beg to state that on the 23rd of
August I had the honor of an in-
terview with both the Governor and
Governor General at Foochow at
their yamen, on the subject of re-
pairing the road and building
a lighthouse in Southern Formosa.
I told their Excellencies that it
appears from information received
from you that on the 29th of
June last the Tsung li Yamen
had not yet received any report
concerning my agreement of
the 11th year, 2nd moon and 4th day,
and hence my Communication
No 73 to you furnishing the first-

intimation that the Yamen had
of my proceedings in Southern
Formosa. I added that the Min-
isters had readily assented to all
the arrangements that had been
agreed upon excepting the light-
house matter, and that they had
promised to send at once a des-
patch instructing the Viceroy that
if the said lighthouse could be
built and maintained without serious
risks, to proceed with the work, and
therefore I suggested the advisability
of their Excellencies writing again
in case they had not heard from
Peking, or if they preferred it, to
send a duplicate of their former
report either through me or by a
special courier. The Governor General
replied that he had reported to the
Tsung Li Yamen upon the agreement
of the 11th year 2nd year and 4th day,
but as yet he had received no reply
from the Yamen; yet in compliance
with the terms of the agreement,
without waiting for instructions —

from Peking. the Intendent of Formosa,
by his order, had already purchased at
Amoy the material for building barracks
at Tasoupong, at the cost of the Provincial
Treasury; the same had been sent to
its destination and preparatory steps
had been taken for reopening the road.
All that was now needed to carry out
the balance of the programme was
money and an order from the Central
Government; and he concluded by saying
that, inasmuch as I had been so often
deceived in this case, if I doubted his
statements he would be pleased to hear
that I had gone to Southern Formosa
in order to satisfy myself by personal
observation.

I may remark in connection with
this that, since my return to Amoy,
I have received an official communica-
tion from the Taotai of Taiwan, and also
a private note from the Taotai of
Formosa, informing me that the
road had been reopened and that they
were only waiting for instructions
from Peking to commence work on

the lighthouse; and I have positive information that the building of the Barracks at Tong Liu has already been commenced and that an officer on the staff of the Military Commander of the Island, holding the rank of Brigadier-General, has visited the spot for the purpose of selecting a site whereon to erect barracks for the Quartering of the troops which are to be stationed there.

In the course of my conversation with the Viceroy, and in reply to my Query as to whether His Excellency thought that Mr. Hart would lend us his aid in carrying out the terms of the agreement of the 11th year 2nd moon and 4th day, that officer gave it as his opinion that, had the Inspector-General been favorably inclined to our plan, it would have been communicated long ago. This statement on the part of the Viceroy is interesting, knowing that Mr. Hart was in Foochow just before I arrived there and must have had an interview with the Governor-General; and I do not consider it at all improbable that the story which is related in the Customs' Gazette of July 3rd 1872, that three junks belonging to Taiwanfoo engaged in trade with the aboriginal tribes on the East Coast, were attacked and plundered by pirates in the neighborhood of Liang Kiau on the 20th of May last, and also the story of the attack on the soldiers sent by the Tu to reckon the road, after the Tin Tautai had left his post to return to Foochow, (Enclosure No 1), have both been circulated by certain Chinese in the employ of the Taiwan Authorities for the purpose of strengthening the position of the Inspector General in the opposition which the declaration of the Viceroy leads me to suppose he is making to the carrying out of our plans in Southern Formosa. If this is the case, it is not the first time that I have met with opposition on the part of the Foreign Branch of the Imperial Maritime Customs. When in 1867, I endeavored to

persuade the Chinese to organize an Armed force to go to Southern Formosa and punish the aborigines, they were continually quoting the opinions of the Commissioner of Customs at Tamsui, which were in direct opposition to my views. Enclosure No 2 is a copy of one of the numerous letters which I received, and wherein this opposition is made apparent.

In replying to the Governor-General's statement concerning Mr. Hart, I suggested that if indeed the Inspector-General was, as was apprehended, unable or unwilling to provide for the erection of the lighthouse, etc., inasmuch as that work must go on and the road reopened because of a political necessity, with the aid of the provincial authorities a sum of money sufficient for the purpose might be raised in some other way and through other sources; and if I could judge from what the Army Chairman had officially communicated to me concerning the cost of erecting the lighthouse at Chapel Island, the first outlay in putting up a lighthouse at South Bay, reopening the road, paying indemnities to the aborigines, etc, would not exceed $40,000 and probably much less. Although I knew that this sum could not well be raised by increasing the Likin taxes in Formosa where the trade requires rather to be encouraged than to be hampered by heavy imposts, I was quite sure that it might be obtained by slightly increasing the tales, say by twelve and a half cents per picul, as tea grown in both the Amoy and Tea Chow districts, and could scarcely be felt by either the growers or the Consumers, and yet, in two years, this additional tax would amount to about $138,883, that is to say, not only enough to provide for the first outlay, but amply sufficient for the keeping of the lighthouse and road, and the fulfilling of obligations to the Aborigines for many years to come. (See Customs Returns).

The Governor General thanked me for having gone so deeply into the subject, but, as for raising money through the Likin, he advised me to consult the Collector of Internal Revenue (Likin Board) of the

Province, keeping in mind however, that no money can be raised from the Fukkien and Kelung Lekin without the sanction of the Board of Revenue, or Hoo Poo, at Peking.

Agreeably to the Viceroy's suggestion, I called upon Ngah, the Collector of Internal Taxes. He is a mandarin of high rank wearing a red button of the third order, and, at the same time, is the native director of the Arsenal at Foochow. He has lately been appointed Intendant of Formosa by Imperial Decree, and will proceed to his post shortly after Chinese New Year. Apparently he is well disposed, very able, is said to know much of Foreigners, and according to the statements of reliable persons, can be depended on in a measure. I may say, in connection with this, that he promises to do all in his power to forward the execution of my plans as approved by yourself as soon as he assumes his office in Formosa. But for the present, he opposed the plan of raising money from the Lekin of the whole Province of Fukkien, and strongly advocated the advisability of obtaining it from the Treasury of the Island, instead. The matter having been submitted to the Viceroy, His Excellency acquainted us with his decision, on the 16th of August, in the following terms:—

"Your letter (the Consuls') came to our "Yamen, and we looked into the matter. "The original agreement proposed to meet "the expenses of this case by deducting a "sufficient sum of money for that purpose "from the Tonnage dues Fund. The orig- "inal agreement bears the seals (of Author- "ities) and the work must go on. We, the "Viceroy and Governor, have already reported "the case to Peking. On the 16th day, ya- "meen, (August 19th) you, the Honorable "Consul, came to Foochow to inquire as to "whether we had received the approval of "the Tsung Li Yamen. As the Inspector General "has not replied to the Communication ad- "dressed to him by the Tsung Li Yamen, we "are of opinion that the idea does not meet "with his approbation. × × × × × × The "Lekin duties of Formosa must be used in "Formosa in a particular manner as provi- "ded for by law. The lighthouse must be

"built with money deducted from the Tonnage
"Dues Fund as set forth in the original
"agreement. As soon as we receive a reply
"from the Tsung Li Yamen we will consider
"what to do, and do the best we can.
"We have sent copies of this letter to the
"Taotai of Formosa and the Board of Trade
" at Foochow. × × × × ".

23rd day, 7th moon, 11th year of Tung Chih.
(August 26th, 1872.)

My impression is that the Governor-General, having approved the agreement entered into with me by the Taiwan Authorities on the 4th day, 2nd moon, 11th year of Tung Chih, will be entirely guided by its stipulations, and, considering that inasmuch as he has so far fulfilled the obligations incumbent on him by the terms of the agreement by building, at the expense of the Provincial Treasury, the Yamens and soldiers' Quarters at Tung Kee, and taking, at his own risk, the initiatory steps towards reopening the road, he will remain perfectly indifferent to the embarrassments which may result to the Tsung Li Yamen from the non fulfilment of any promise which the latter may have made to you in connection with the reopening of the road, the paying of indemnities to the Aborigines, and the building of the lighthouse, those being matters which under the agreement, concern exclusively the Central Government and which that Government should attend to at its own risk and upon its own responsibility.

With the Local Authorities of Taiwan it will be different; and inasmuch as the inactivity on the part of the Central Government secure to them freedom from embarrassments and labor, they will always be ready to find excuses for themselves for not fulfilling their obligations knowing that by so doing they will coincide with the wishes of their Imperial masters, which as of old will be confidentially made known to them although assurances to the contrary will be made to you by the Tsung Li Yamen. But, if instead of encouraging them in thus acting, the Central Government were to give them to understand that the first [illegible]

for the stipulations set forth in the agreement to be carried out without delay, and if the Foreign Branch of Imperial Maritime Customs, instead of opposing us as of old, were to give us their cordial support, the Scheme as originally devised by me, and as I had the honour to explain it to you in my No. 93, would be consummated without any serious difficulty.

It seems to me that if the Tonnage Fund is already expended, and that the Inspector General, though willing to cooperate with us for the carrying out of this plan, is prevented from so doing by the want of means, there is no option but for the Tsung Li Yamen to make a sufficient appropriation from the Likin of Fukien and Chekiang in the way I have proposed. And if this cannot be done I would respectfully suggest that the Customs General be instructed to deduct whatever money may be required from the 3% of the proceeds of the Maritime Revenue collected by the Foreign Branch of the Imperial Maritime Customs, and which is annually set aside for the use of the Central Government. This has been done, I believe, in former times and for other purposes and might be resorted to again in this case.

I did not have the honor of an interview with the Inspector General when he passed through Amoy, but his private secretary, Mr. Dean, whom I had known in old time both in Amoy and Formosa as Commissioner of Customs, came to see me several times. I did not communicate to him in detail the points of the agreement of the 11th year 2nd moon, 4th day, as I did not know whether you wished me to do so; but I told him, in a General way that there was now a proposition before the Tsung Li Yamen to erect a lighthouse at the Southernmost point of Formosa, and that I now thought of respectfully suggesting to you the advisability of concerting with the Inspector-General in order to secure the cooperation

of the Collector of Customs at Takao. He confidentially replied to me that Mr. Hart shared the prejudices of many other persons about Formosa, and might not be so anxious as I supposed, to forward my views. He further said that he would gladly return there if Mr. Hart directed him to do so, and would give him sufficient inducement in the way of salary, and so define his duties towards the aborigines that he could undertake to perform what was expected of him with confidence of ultimate success. I believe this Gentleman to be more capable than any other person I know of to aid the Chinese in effecting the completion of any scheme, for the furtherance of internal improvements, with the aborigines of Southern Formosa. By reference to my No 43 to your predecessor, you will perceive that in view of my possible recall from this coast at the end of Mr. Johnson's term, I had brought

Mr. Man to the Chief of the eighteen tribes and had acquainted him with my plans that he might aid my successor in promoting the accomplishment of my scheme for the pacification of Southern Formosa, should he be called upon to do so by the Legation and the Imperial Government. Now that my former Interpreter, Mr. Pickering, has left Formosa for Singapore where he has been appointed Colonial Chinese Interpreter the services of Mr. Man would be still more required at Takao. For, after I shall have left Amoy, Mr. Man and the Consular Clerk, James Johnston will be the only persons who can serve as a medium of communication between Tan tee Tan and either the Chinese or ourselves; and Johnston being entirely uneducated would be scarcely fitted to perform these duties.

A few months ago I respectfully informed you that in case of my confirmation as Minister to the Argentine Republic I would be obliged to leave China in a reasonably short time; but that, before I went, I would gladly undertake to bring to a satisfactory issue the affairs connected with Southern Formosa, should you desire me to do so. On the 29th of June, you did me the honor to write to me that in view of the delay that must necessarily occur before the Yamen would be prepared to give you the definite answer you were looking for, I would hardly be justified in delaying my departure for my new post.

On the 28th of June I had the honor of writing to you that I had reason to believe that the Senate

had adjourned without taking action on my nomination, and that it was very likely that I should remain in China a sufficient length of time to close up my business in Southern Formosa. I then felt quite confident that this could be done by October. Now I see that you were right and I was wrong, and that I cannot possibly expect to receive your final instructions before the end of November, and that if I wish to finish this business, I must be prepared to remain here until January, 1873. The loss of money accruing to me from the difference between the salaries of Minister to the Argentine Republic and Consul at Amoy would not have deterred me from remaining here a few months longer to close up a business

which I hold to be of much importance to the Government, and which I had originated; but, as it is, pressing family matters compel me to leave for home early in October (Enclosure No. 3). You may rest assured that, before I leave Amoy, I will make such arrangements, of which you shall be advised, as will allow of the business being carried on in the same manner as if there was a regular officer here having no other duties to perform than those connected with the Consulate, and I am sure that the public service will not suffer by my absence.

I have etc

Signed Chas W Le Geyt

Enclosure No 1 with Despatch No 82

The Taiwan Fu, Chin, Ching Tantai of Formosa, hereby makes a communication.

I write this letter to remind you that the former Tantai, Tin, entered into an agreement with you to open the road through as far as Hong Kong. This case has been reported to the higher Authorities at Foochow, by the former Tantai, and he appointed Wang Wing Kee, the Hien of Chang Wah, together with the Hien of Tung Shaw, called Sung Kee Tchoo, to go and examine the road for the purpose of reopening it. On the 22nd day, 7th moon of this year (August 20th, 1872) they sent in their report as follows:- "We "received orders from their Excellencies " to go and reopen the road to Hong " Kong that people may travel on " it, and His Excellency, the General, "sent soldiers to help my men in " the work. I, Wong Wing Kee, " went to the Tung Shan Hien, " Sung Kee Tchoo, and we ordered

"the head men of Hong Kong, Kiang
"Kiau, and the other villages, to
"work day and night and hurry
"up the reopening of the road. I,
"Wong Wung Kee, begged their Excellencies
"to give me One Thousand Dollars to
"pay my expenses, which money I
"have received and used for the public
"benefit. After that, the head men of
"Kiang Kiau brought the head men
"of all the villages as far as
"Pong Lee to their Hein, who ex-
"plained to them the orders of his
"Excellency the Tautai, and gave
"them money ordering them to
"hire men immediately, pay their
"expenses, and set them to work
"at once. I, Kee Tcheo, having
"some important business connected
"with foreigners to attend to,
"dared not go and look after
"the road business. On the 5th
"day 6th moon of this year (July
"10th 1872) I, Wung Kee, went to
"Pong Lee and received all the
"head men, who reported to me
"that everything had been done as
"ordered. The next day I left Pong
"Lee to examine all the places
"along the road, and that same
"evening I arrived at Hong Kong.
"On the 7th day July 12th) I was at
"Kiang Kiau, also called Chasiang.
"All along the road I could see
"mountains, forests, rivers, and the
"sea. Every part of the road had
"been cleared. Some high mountains
"could not be passed over by a
"carriage or a chair, but could be
"traversed on foot without any
"trouble. After I had finished my
"examination, I waited until the 11th
"day (July 16th) and then started to
"come back overland. On the 12th
"day (July 17th) between three and
"four o'clock in the afternoon,
"while passing the Pong Lee hill,
"about ten or more lis (between three
"and four miles) from Pong Lee, some
"savages, hidden behind trees and
"in caves, fired at us with bird
"muskets and struck two volunteer

soldiers, one named Ee Ah Dong and Kwoa Ah Ur. Ee Ah Dong was shot through the breast and killed instantly. Kwoa Ah Ur was shot through the left leg and fell on the Ground badly wounded. I, Wong Kee, took all the head men, the soldiers, my men and the Volunteer soldiers and looked everywhere for the murderers, but the trees being so very thick, we could find none of them, and consequently we cannot say how many there were. The Volunteer soldier Kwoa Ah Ur, who was wounded so badly, died shortly afterwards. I then I sent the head men to all the different village with orders to try and discover the murderers; and I offered a reward of Fifty dollars to any One who should seize them or give such information as would lead to their being caught. The Pong Lee people told us that in all the villages along the road there were a great many bad people who made it a practice to come out of their villages and lay in ambush near the road for the purpose of waylaying travellers and killing them. They have no head man to look after them. I remained there five days but could discover nothing, and on the 18th day July 23/ came back to the city of the Hien. Then I carefully considered the case of these savages. When they meet together they always want to kill some one, and make it their business to do so. They hide themselves in the thick trees and in deep caves where they can see us though we cannot see them. They even sometimes hide themselves in the Sword-Grass. They understand well how to shoot, too. In the 6th year when the former General, Lew, opened this road, he took a large body of soldiers, besides hiring one thousand native volunteers, and posted them in different places to guard against the savages. After this, the road being opened, people must pass. But how are they to protect themselves? Truly I cannot see how they can do it. And how can the murderers be seized? Consul Lee,

When the road was opened, thought that if a vessel was wrecked, soldiers would protect the crew along this road. But the savages know nothing about law, they never try to be good, and if a vessel is wrecked, and the crew while passing along the road, get hurt, what can we do? When I considered all these things I felt as though I was standing on water. When people in any of the villages are killed by the savages, they never report the matter to the Government. I called the relations and friends of the two men who were killed, and though they said nothing against the government, yet I could judge what they felt in their hearts and killed them. This case is connected with the interests of both Chinese and foreigners, and must be reported plainly. I, Wang Lee, examined the bodies of the men who were killed, provided them with good coffins and other things necessary for their burial, and gave money to their families and took care of them. Now I must report to you that the road is reopened and that two men are killed; and I petition your Excellency to inform Consul Lee of these facts. An early compliance with this my request, will be of beneficial result to the public good."

The above petition came to my Yamen and I examined into the case of the savages hiding in the mountains and there waiting to kill people. If a man passes that place it is very hard for him to protect himself. I have looked into their petition and I think there is something in it. Therefore I reply to them, and send this letter to you for your information.

I must request you to inform the foreign merchants that, although the road is opened, they must not travel on it as they please, for, if they get killed by the savages, the Chinese local Authorities could find it impossible to arrest their murderers.

1st day, 8th moon, 11th year of Tung Chih.

(September 3rd 1872.)

To General Chas. W. Le Gendre,
United States Consul for Amoy
and Formosa.

P.S. Two days after the date of
the above letter, the Tu of Taiwan,
Hsu, wrote another letter to the
U. S. Consul, the same as the
above.

I beg to reply to you. I
have given orders to reopen
the road in Formosa at once.
Concerning the lighthouse, I
must wait for orders from
my superior, and then I
will take the necessary
steps. According to your
wish I write you this
note, with best regard.

(signed) Lin Tsu Kah
(Tautai of Formosa)

18th day, 7th moon (August 21st, 1872)

Enclosure No 2
with Despatch No 82.

General Lew, Taotai Woo & Foo, Yeh, officiating at Kaoukaofoo, Lew this communication.

{Extract} x x the Tung Shan Hsien, who, report that he went, in company with the Colonel of Ng Kwan Yun to Takao where they saw the British Consul, Carroll, and the Commissioner of Customs, White, who agree in stating that the aborigines resemble wild beasts and that they can not comprehend the usages of civilization Society. Further that the Savages conceal themselves in the forests of the country, open fire upon those who approach, thus making it exceedingly difficult to employ troops. x x x x x

To Lee,[1] Ll. S. Consul, Amoy.

15th day, 2d moon, 6th year

19th april, 1867.

(1) Le Gendre.